

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- The moment we've all been dreading: how to handle objections
- As a fitness coach you are going to get objections. Period, the end.
- It's just going to happen, and it will happen alot.
- Relying solely on lay down clients will not get your business to the level you need it to

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- As a business owner you need to learn how to handle objections
- This one skill can significantly increase the amount of clients you sign
- The reason why trainers feel uncomfortable handling objections is because they think they need to be pushy or uncomfortable

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- These are old tactics that worked decades ago before online reviews and word of mouth spread so fast
- You could get away with submitting people into buying because youd never see or hear from them
- This is unethical and outdated

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- In today's world, we practice what's called solution based sales
- This is a method of handling objections by helping your potential clients find a solution that will help them overcome their roadblock
- There's no pushing, only collaboration

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Imagine sitting on the same side of the table looking at a challenge together, rather than sitting across from each other in battle
- This new approach will allow you to overcome your potential clients objections, while maintaining a good relationship, without being pushy.

OBJECTION PSYCHOLOGY

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- There's 3 important steps to understand to handling objections
- I personally don't believe in a canned "if they say this, say that" response.
- It's not genuine, it's not authentic, and most of them are cheap tactics

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- What works better is to understand the what an objection actually is, and how to overcome them individually
- The first step here is curiosity
- If you get an objection, do not respond with a canned “objection handler” response
- Have curiosity and explore the objection

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- What you need to know is that an objection is a GENUINE CONCERN that your potential client has
- If they are giving you an objection, its not because they dont want to join the program its because there is something about your program they are genuinely concerned about.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- So you need to accept that when you get an objection, its because something about your program isnt a good fit
- You need to figure out what it is about your program or their situation thats a concern
- When you look at it this way, you're not pushing anyone. You're simply exploring

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Approach this genuine concern with curiosity. (we will go into tactics and scripts later in this lesson)
- Ask questions about your prospects concerns to discover where their objection lies.
- Once you have a good understanding of where their true objection is, you want to offer solutions to help them overcome that objection.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Offering solutions (like payment plans, additional support, guarantees, etc) will tailor your offer to better fit your prospects needs and concerns
- This also shows that your willing to make your program work for your prospect
- If they genuinely want to join, they will reciprocate by accepting an offer that better fits them

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Lastly, if the offers you suggest still don't align, be willing to negotiate.
- You own the business so you decide how far you need to go to sign this client
- The possibilities are endless here
- For example: a discounted rate in exchange for a testimonial, first month free, money back guarantee, etc.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- These are more rules and guidelines of handling objections more than tactics to use in the field.
- Understand the objection is a genuine concern
- Approach the genuine concern with curiosity
- Offer solutions to the genuine concern
- Negotiate

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If your prospect has a real objection that can be overcome using the solution based sales method, they will appreciate you for working it out with them
- Remember an objection doesn't mean your prospect doesn't want to join your program. It's up to you to figure out what they need in order to say yes.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If you cant seem to overcome the objections using the methods were going to show you, then it means the prospect wasnt going to close anyway
- Unfortunately you will come across liars in the business, where people will say one thing but mean another. Dont get too caught up in this.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Do your best to genuinely help your potential clients work through their roadblocks
- Write this down on a sticky note and put it next to your laptop:
- Objections are genuine concerns
- Approach genuine concerns with curiosity
- Offer solutions
- Negotiate

OBJECTION FRAMEWORK

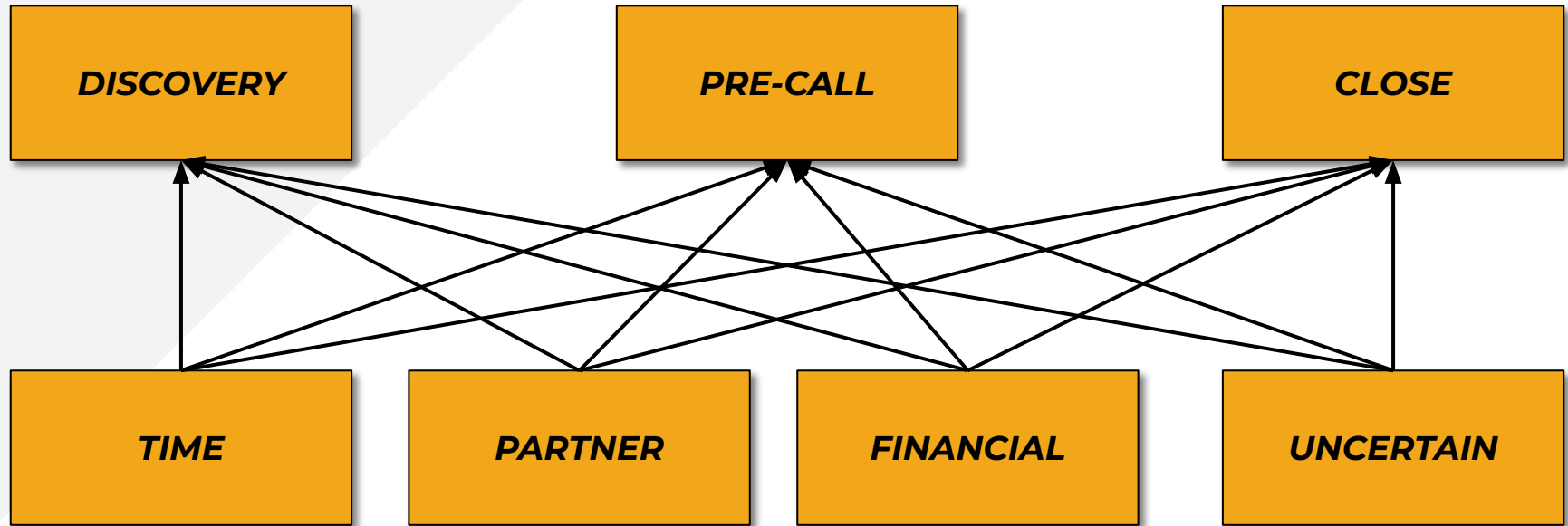
HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- The model I'm about to show you for handling objections looks scary and confusing, but I promise its not as hard as it looks
- There are 4 main types of objections: Time, Partner, Financial, and Uncertainty
- There are 3 places to handle objections: Discovery Call, Pre-Call, and Close

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- This model will have you solving all 4 objections at all 3 places where you can handle objections
- This allows you to handle objections early on before price is revealed so that people don't make illogical arguments
- You want to handle objections when your potential client is speaking from a logical state of mind as early in the call as possible

Opportunities to Handle Objections



Types of Objections

DISCOVERY OBJECTIONS

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- The first opportunity you have to handle objections is at the end of the discovery call
- This is an opportunity where you can fish for red flag objections that may come up in the sales call
- Here you don't necessarily need to solve or overcome objections, but you'll want to see what concerns they might have

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- For each 4 types of objections you are going to ask a question that will give you a better idea on their situation relative to the objection
- For time ask: “Is now a good time for you to take action on your goals? Would there be any reason stopping you if everything is a good fit?”
- Here you want to take note of what they say, you will use that later to hold them accountable

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If someone here expresses a genuine concern like they are going on vacation or in the middle of a move then ask if:
 - 1) You came up with a custom plan to work around their obligations they could commit
 - 2) there's a better time for them to get started (like a week or after the move)

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If they're not in a position to take action right away, it's best to save the call until a better time
- Otherwise they will use that objection later in the sales call
- But if they say now is a good time and a custom solution to work around their obligation works then you can hold them accountable and call them out on their objection later

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- For partner objection at the end of the disco call ask: “Is there anyone you need to speak to before making an investment in yourself? Does your partner know you’ll be on this call?”
- If they say no, then hold them accountable
- If they say yes they need to speak to a partner, then ask them to speak to their partner before the call.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- This way the partner knows the call will be taking place and they can talk about the opportunity before hand
- You can ask to bring the partner on the call as well that is a easy solution to sell the partner
- It's much easier to sell the partner yourself rather than your prospect relaying the message

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- At the end of the disco you can ask if your prospect is ready to invest
- Here you can say: “If everything looks like a good fit, we can talk about what it’d look like to work together. There will be an investment, is that something you have resources for?”

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- 9/10 times they will ask you here about the price
- Say: “We’ll go over the price and details on tomorrows call, but if the price is right are you in a position to make an investment?”
- You want to see if they have the resources and is a good time for them to invest.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Any red flags would be if they lost their job, in the middle of a move, in college, etc.
- If you discover that finances is an issue early on then you can hold off on the sales call until they are in a better financial decisions
- Here you want to make sure that they know there's an investment and they have the resources

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Uncertainty based objections are “I need to think about it”
- Here there is usually a reason that holds them back, like nerves or specific conditions
- Here you will ask: “Would there be anything that would stop you from getting started? What might get in the way of taking action?”

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- This will prompt them to admit any objection that may come up on the sales call, giving you an early opportunity to offer a solution and affirming their decision before moving forward

PRE-CALL OBJECTIONS

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- The pre-call objection opportunity is in the beginning of the sales call after setting the intention for the call and before diving into the roadmap
- Here you will take a moment to ask them a question for each objection

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- For time ask: “Before we dive into this call, I want to make sure now is a good time for you. Are you in a position to take action or will there be any reason for you to not get started?”
- If they say now is a good time for them to take action, then take note as to why now is a good time and use that as leverage

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If they express that now may not be a good time approach this genuine concern with curiosity and ask questions.
- Why is now not a good time? What do you have coming up? Is it something that you can work around?

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Once you discover what the true objection may be ask: “If we can create a custom solution to work through this block, would you be able to take action?”
- You want to see if they are flexible to work through this objection with you

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If they say yes, then be ready to negotiate terms that will best fit their needs at the end of the call
- If their concern is something that you can overcome then and there then do it on the spot
- For example: if they're concerned they only have 3 days a week to workout, then assure them that they can make progress with a custom plan

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- For partner, in the beginning of the call ask: “Is there anyone you will need to speak to for making a decision today? Do they know you’re on this call? Is it possible for them to be here?”
- If they say there’s no one for them to speak to then proceed to the call

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If there is someone they need to speak to, ask if its possible for them to be on the call
- If that's not possible record the call and send it to them after the call is over
- It is much easier to sell the partner with your call recording then through a relayed message.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- For Financial ask: “Are you prepared to make an investment in yourself if this is a good fit? Are you financially in a position to take action?”
- If they say yes, then proceed with the sales call
- If they ask what the price is, or it depends on the price mention that you will cover price in detail at the end, but want to make sure they are in a position to make a decision

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- What you don't want here is to be on the call with someone who's unable to make a financial decision all together, i.e they're moving, or unemployed etc.
- If you happen to be on the phone with someone who is unable to make a financial decision proceed with the call but expect to plant a seed

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- For uncertainty objections, you want to ask your potential client ahead of time: “What might hold you back from getting started today? What concerns or hesitations do you have about getting started?”
- This will prompt your potential client one last time to think of any uncertainty based concerns they have

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Doing so will give you an opportunity to address their concerns
- By this point you have had the opportunity to handle 4 major objections 2 times. If theyve made it this far then they are qualified to take action at the end of the call

THE CLOSE

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- The close marks the second half of the sales call. This is where if your prospect has an objection it will come out.
- Every now and then there will be what's called a lay-down sale. But most of your potential clients will have an objection after the price reveal

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- It is best to expect an objection at this point in the call so you are not surprised when it comes
- The first step to handle this objection is to first acknowledge, respond, and ask
- Respect the objection and give your prospect space

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- You do not have to dive right into handling the objection right away, it is okay for you to pause and take a second
- Remember, an objection is a genuine concern. Instead of going into trying to solve the objection right away, go into curiosity mode

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Also remember that you are here on this call to help your potential clients think it through and make an informed decision
- It is likely they will say: “Can I take some time to think about it?”
- Or “I need to check my finances”
- Or “I need to talk to my partner”

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Acknowledge, Respond, and Ask
- You'll say: "I totally understand if you need to (insert their objection), I would too if I were you. Is it okay if I ask you a question?"
- What you want to do next is build a case around your program to make sure its a good fit

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Sometimes if your prospect isn't 100% sold on your program they will use an objection as a lie to not sign up
- So the first step is to ensure your potential client wants to join the program, then you can move onto solving the objection

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- You'll say: "Is there anything about the program that you're unsure of? Do you believe the program will help you? And do you want to join?"
- Before solving the objection, you want to make sure your client 100% wants to join the program or discover if there's another reason that's holding them back

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If your potential client is unsure that they want to join 100% then you need to work with them by answering their concerns and affirming your program until they are 100% sold that your program is the best solution for them
- If they are 100% sold and want to move forward, but still have that objection. Isolate the objection

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- You want to make sure that the reason they are giving an objection, is the sole reason they are giving an objection
- You dont want to be solving multiple objections at once, so the best way to do this is by isolating the true objection

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- The reason why handling objections is difficult is because we don't know what the true objection is half the time. If we did, it would be easy to overcome
- So the key here is to discover what the true objection is

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- To do this ask: “Is (their objection) the only thing holding you back? Is there any other reason you may not be able to start today?”
- Try to fish for as many objections as you can get out of them
- If they have more than one, then youll need to overcome each individually

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If they only have one then you can proceed.
- Before diving into each objection ask: “If we can come up with a solution to overcome this together, would you be opposed to moving forward with us?”
- This is a simple ask to work together if you overcome the objection

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If their objection is time, then you will need to investigate what about time are they concerned about
- Are they concerned that they won't have enough time in the day? Are they concerned they won't have enough time in the week? Are they concerned because they're going on vacation?

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Ask questions to discover what about time they are concerned about
- You will need to be flexible with your solutions here and offer ideas, be willing to negotiate as well
- Lets say they are concerned about a vacation coming up half way through the program

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Here you can say: “I understand your concern, but theres no need to wait to take action for 6 weeks when we both know you can start making progress by next week. How about we work together up until your vacation, and I can coach your through your vacation so that you stay on track and come back on the right foot. Sound good?”

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If they're concerned about not having enough time in the week you can say: "I understand you are concerned about not having enough time, but if we don't make time we'll never find it. We can build you a custom workout plan to get the results you're looking for and fit your busy schedule. Sound fair?"

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Essentially you want to address their concerns by offering a custom solution that they will say yes to.
- After offering a solution that they agree to, re-ask for the sale
- “Awesome, I’m glad we can come to a solution on that. Are you ready to move forward?”

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- The partner objection will be the only objection that might need a follow up call
- When a potential client needs to speak to their partner it's for 1 of 2 reasons
 - 1) Respect
 - 2) Permission

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If the prospect needs to speak to their partner out of respect it means they have the decision making power, but want their partner to be brought up to speed before saying yes
- If they need permission then it means they need their partners approval in order for them to join

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- To figure out which is which ask: “I totally understand that you need to bring your partner into this, just out of curiosity is it out of respect or permission?”
- Their answer to this question will determine how you will schedule the follow up

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If it's out of respect then your prospect won't need much time. All they'll need is a few minutes to speak to their partner
- You can say: "Perfect, if you need to take 5-10 minutes to give your partner a call and let her know I can wait on this call."

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Getting your prospect to move forward on the call is always best case scenario
- If your prospect needs time to speak to their partner then try to book a follow up call for later that same night or the next day
- It doesn't take 2 weeks for someone to talk to their partner. Keep the decision making window short

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If your prospect needs to speak to their partner out of permission, that means that you will have to win over their partners decision to. AKA you need to sell them
- You cannot rely on your prospect to sell your product better than you can

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- This is why its important to record your calls
- Here to can start to address the concerns their partner might have on the call
- You will ask: “What concerns will your partner have about the program? What deciding factors are important to them? What do they need to hear in order for them to say yes?”

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Your prospect will let you know what their partner needs to hear. This will allow you to address those concerns for their partner on the call
- The important key here is to send the call recording to your prospect to have their partner watch the presentation

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- On the recording they will hear you address the concerns that they have
- To execute this say: “Awesome, what I’ll do is send you this call recording. That way your partner can listen to the presentation themselves. Would you be able to show it to them for me?”

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Here you will need to schedule a follow up
- Again schedule the follow up for as soon as possible
- People do not need 2 weeks to make a decision, they will know within 24 hours
- Schedule the follow up within 72 hours of the call

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- For financial objections you want to fully understand their financial situation
- Its impossible to know whether a financial objection is a true financial objection until you know their full situation
- This strategy is advanced, it will take practice and confidence

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- The first step to overcome a financial objection is to isolate. You want to know if finances is the only true objection
- You'll ask: "Are finances the only thing in your way from getting started?"
- Then ask for collaboration

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- You'll ask: "If we can come up with a solution together that makes sense financially, would you be opposed to moving forward today?"
- You want to get them to agree that if they can financially afford your services they will sign up
- What you will need to do here is lay out all of their resources available

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- To do this say: “Perfect, I’d love to create a custom payment plan that will work for you financially. In order to do that I’ll need to know what you have available. Is it okay to have an honest conversation so we can come up with a solution together?”
- The key here is to ask permission to keep rapport

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- What you will need to know is 3 things:
- 1) what credit do they have available
- 2) what is their cash on hand
- 3) what is their monthly income
- When you learn the answers to these questions you will know what they can or cant afford

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Do execute this say: “Perfect, so the first thing I’ll need to know is if you have any available credit. Do you have any credit available that you can use and if so how much?”
- Next ask for cash on hand: “How much do you have in savings that your willing and able to invest?”

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Lastly ask: “How much do you have left over after expenses each month that your willing and able to invest?”
- You should end this conversation with 3 numbers that will give you a running total of their available resources.

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- In some cases you'll find that your potential client has 0 credit, 0 savings, and no income
- This is a true financial objection, they simply do not have the resources available.
- In this case end the call by setting up a follow up date in the near future for them to save up for

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- You'll find in most cases your potential client will have the resources available
- In this case you can offer a payment plan that will work for them, or a discount to get them to pay in full if you see that's an option for them
- Be willing to negotiate here if you see that they have the financial resources available

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If you find that they 1) have the time 2) dont need to speak to their partner 3) have the financial resources and 4) believe in your product, and STILL wont sign
- Then its likely nerves
- Here you will need to call them out on their nerves, and coach them through taking action

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- You'll say: "So I can see here that we have the resources, and time available to make this happen. You know this is what you need to do. Is it just nerves that's holding you back? I assure you that if you follow everything on the plan, you will be successful. How does that sound?"

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- If you've gone through all of these objections, and they still want time to think about it. Its likely that they wont close
- There's an unfortunate saying in sales that goes "Buyers and Liars".
- In some cases this is true. Some people will lie their way out of a close

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- These are frustrating because they're impossible to overcome. You will just have to accept that it will happen every now and then
- If you have a prospect not close on a call you will need to schedule a follow up date to close
- Do not let your prospect off the phone without scheduling a time for a follow up in the calendar

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- To do this ask: “What day and time works best to touch base on a decision in the next 3 days?”
- People do not need 2 weeks to make a decision, they will know within a few days.
- Once you have them on the calendar thank them for their time and move on to your next lead

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- To conduct a follow up call is really simple, all you need to do is touch base and see if they've made a decision.
- From there you will either onboard them, or wish them luck

HANDLING OBJECTIONS

- Lesson Complete